

Mingyue Zha

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EDUCATION

Dartmouth College

B.A. Quantitative Social Science (Psychology Concentration), GPA: 4.00/4.00

- Minors in Neuroscience & Chemistry, Premed Track

Hanover, NH

Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2027

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stamps Scholar Research (advised by Prof. Herbert Chang & Yusaku Horiuchi) Apr. 2025 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Using Stamps Scholarship to conduct independent research on mental health and digital platforms
- First study used visual and large language processing to examine social anxiety content on 400,000+ videos; Second study examined geographic and linguistic inequalities of AI health overviews on search engines; Currently conducting senior thesis

Visiting Researcher, Digital Mental Health Lab (advised by Dr. Amy Orben) Jun. – Sep. 2026

University of Cambridge, Dept. of Psychology

Cambridge, UK

- Analyzed relationship between social media beauty content exposure and adolescent body image using real social media watch histories and ecological momentary assessments from UK adolescents
- Supported policy-facing work and evidence synthesis on youth digital wellbeing, presented rapid evidence review on age of smartphone acquisition and impact on youth mental health and academic attainment to UK Department of Education

Quantitative Social Science Researcher (advised by Prof. Herbert Chang) Sep. 2023 – Apr. 2025

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Led multiple peer-reviewed studies examining mental health, gender inequality, and political discourse on digital platforms
- Created pipeline to scrape and download TikTok data; collected and analyzed 2,000,000+ videos for 2024 US election project

Research Assistant, AI & Mental Health Lab (advised by Dr. Michael Heinz) Sep. 2023 – Sep. 2024

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Supported development and evaluation of Therabot, an AI-powered mental health chatbot; contributions ranged from literature reviews, model training, and structured clinical interviews with patients diagnosed with mood and cannabis use disorders

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Co-Founder & Vice President, FORT Jan. 2026 – Present

501(c)(3) Mental Health Nonprofit

Northeast US

- Co-founded a nonprofit expanding access to youth mental health care across the Northeast; fund-raised \$20,000+ in our first year and provided financial assistance to 50 youths, covering costs of therapy and mental health treatments
- Coordinate volunteers and educational programming to increase awareness of mental health and wellbeing

President, Mental Health Union Mar. 2025 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Organizing campus events to raise awareness of mental health issues and resources; advocating for policies
- Creating Dartmouth's Mental Health First Aid (MHFA) course, a 3-week course certifying 100 students in MHFA each year
- Attended Ivy League Mental Health Conference and UN Development Programme Mental Health Symposium 2025 as student delegate, engaging in discussions with former US Surgeon Generals, policymakers, and researchers from around the world

Co-President & Executive Member, Nathan Smith Pre-Health Society Mar. 2024 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Organizing academic and professional opportunities, including guest speaker panels, case studies, and networking events for Nathan Smith Society, Dartmouth's pre-medicine, pre-veterinary, and pre-dental society comprising 1,200+ members
- Leading AI and Health program,

HEALTHCARE EXPERIENCE

Medical Assistant Jan. 2026 – Present

Dartmouth Hitchcock Medical Center, Ophthalmology Clinic

Hanover, NH

- Perform physical exams and workups, chart patient information and histories, and assist physicians and technicians with patient treatment plans

Health Sector Financial Analyst Sep. – Dec. 2025

Tuck Advisors

Solebury, PA

- Assisted with client presentations and strategic recommendations for M&A firm focused on social enterprises in healthcare
- Named Top Intern of cohort and was sole recipient of Senior Analyst return offer (declined)

Health Tech Intern

Aug. – Dec. 2025

Health Tech Without Borders

Boston, MA

- Conducted research and product development for an AI-powered nutrition platform supporting postpartum women in the Philippines, including market analysis, expert interviews, UI, and prototype design

Emergency Room Volunteer

Jun. 2024 - Sep. 2024

Yale New Haven Hospital, Emergency Department

New Haven, CT

- Supported patients, families, and clinical staff in a high-acuity emergency department
- assisted with patient transport and non-clinical support while observing emergency care

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Senior Academic Mentor

Sep. 2026 – Present

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Serving as one of ten seniors hand-picked by academic deans to mentor incoming first-year students
- Holding one-on-one office hours helping students through course selection advising, resource navigation, and community-building

Global Health Fellow

Sep. 2024 – Present

Dartmouth Dickey Center

Hanover, NH

- Planned, organized, and moderated a 3-day visit with Dr. Jim O'Connell, founder of Boston Healthcare for the Homeless Program, for Upper Valley health organizations; attending workshops and panels to discuss global health issues and solutions

Teaching Assistantships

Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025

Dartmouth College

Hanover, NH

- Held office hours and advised 25 students' independent social science projects in QSS 20, Modern Statistical Computing, a course on using Python programming, statistical methods, and machine learning for reproducible social science research
- Led discussion sections, held office hours, and graded exams for 200 students in MUS 46, Video Games and the Meaning of Life, an interdisciplinary course on games, music, and media

PUBLICATIONS

- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2026). Mental Health Discourse on TikTok: Interpreting Multimodal Short-Form Videos at Scale. *Proc. ICWSM Workshop on Digital Minds*. AAAI Press. (Peer-reviewed)
- Chang, H.C.H., ... **Zha, M.**, ... (2026). The Meme Is the Message: Generative Memes and AI Visuals in the 2024 USA Presidential Elections. *Proc. ICWSM*, 20(1), 435–451. (Peer-reviewed)
- Chang, H.C.H., ... **Zha, M.**, ... (2025). Do Language Models Favor Their Home Countries? *HKS Misinformation Review*. (Peer-reviewed)
- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2025). Gender Inequalities in Content Collaborations. *Proc. ICWSM Workshop on Cyber Social Threats*. AAAI Press. (Peer-reviewed)
- Haag, C. & **Zha, M.**, ... (2026). Exposure to Idealized Appearance Content on Social Media and Body Satisfaction in Female Adolescents. *Submitted, Nature Human Behaviour*.
- **Zha, M.** & Chang, H.C.H. (2026). Geographical Inequality of AI Overviews for Health. *Submitted, PNAS Nexus*.
- Chang, H.C.H., **Zha, M.**, Noh, S., Chen, Y.C., Shaman, B., Wei, C., et al. (2024). Visual Politics: TikTok versus Instagram in the 2024 US Presidential Election. *arXiv:2403.03224*. (Non-referred)
- Cheng, W. & **Zha, M.** (Illustrator). *Symphonics*. University of Chicago Press, forthcoming 2027. (Non-referred book)
- **Zha, M.** (2026). *Ming's Aviary*. Substack. <https://substack.com/@mingsaviary>. (Non-referred blog)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Philanthropic Grant of the Class of 1969** (\$10,000, 2026) – competitive grant awarded to one student-led initiative each year; funding is going to Mental Health First Aid initiative
- **Stamps Scholarship** (\$20,000, 2025) – competitive, merit-based scholarship funding two years of independent, faculty-mentored research on digital platforms and health. One of 247 students selected from 413,000+ applicants.
- **Top Paper Award, International Communication Association** (2025) – top-paper honor for first-author research on mental health and gender inequality in online communities
- **Neukom Institute Outstanding Research Prize** (\$750, 2025) – Dartmouth prize recognizing outstanding undergraduate research in computational science
- **Phi Beta Kappa Sophomore Prize** (2025) – awarded to sophomores in top 5% of class, 4.00 GPA
- **James O. Freedman Presidential Scholar** (\$3,400, 2025) – Dartmouth award funding two terms of faculty-mentored research for high-achieving juniors
- **Neukom Scholar** (\$3,400, 2024) – Dartmouth stipend funding a term of faculty-mentored computational research
- **URAD Scholar** (\$3,400, 2024) – Dartmouth stipend funding a term of part-time, faculty-mentored undergraduate research
- **Chia Family Foundation Scholarship** (2023-2026) – scholarship supporting Chinese-American students in higher education

HOBBIES AND INTERESTS

Classical Pianist & Illustrator

- Senior recital, *Seasons of Love*, through Dartmouth's Independent Instructor Program for Classical Piano
- Lead illustrator and collaborator on *Symphonics*, a book on musical improvisation, with Prof. William Cheng